



DECISION

Complaint No. : POS/229/KE/2025

Name and Address of the Complainant : Mst. Sahiban W/o Vikyo Bheel, R/o Gulab Bheel, Goth, Gadap Town, District Malir, Karachi.

Name of the Agency Complained against : Minority Affairs Department, Government of Sindh

Name & Designation of Investigation Officer : Syed Farrukh Habib
Director, Regional Office, Karachi (East)

Subject :- **RE-VALIDATION OF CHEQUE OF RS.5,000/- ISSUED TO COMPLAINANT IN 2022. As FINANCIAL AID**

THE COMPLAINT

Mst. Sahiban, in her complaint dated 10.03.2025, stated that she was issued a cheque amounting to Rs. 5,000/- on account of financial aid by the Minority Affairs Department, Government of Sindh. However, by the time she attempted to encash the cheque, it had expired, rendering it invalid for withdrawal. She has therefore requested that the concerned authority may be directed to issue a fresh cheque, in lieu of the expired one.

PROCEEDINGS

2. After admission of complaint by condoning delay under Section 10 of the Establishment of the Office of Ombudsman for the Province of Sindh Act, 1991, (amended up to date), as well as after receiving mandatory Affidavit on Form "A" and other relevant documents, report was called from the Agency. In response, the Section Officer (Coordination) for Secretary to Government of Sindh, vide letter dated 11.04.2025, forwarded the matter to the Director, Minorities Affairs Department, Government of Sindh, with the direction to examine the contents of the complaint and to take necessary action in accordance with rules and government policy.

3. Subsequently, the Director, Minorities Affairs Department, vide letter dated 26.06.2025 stated that the cheque bearing No. 34964118 dated 12.05.2022 was issued with the approval of the competent forum, i.e., the Sindh Non-Muslims Welfare Committee. However, the cheque became invalid following the lapse of the financial year 2021-22. As per prevailing government policy and financial rules, cheques cannot be revalidated in the subsequent financial year, and accordingly, the unutilized funds were returned to the Finance Department at the close of the fiscal year. It was further informed that such financial assistance is administered under the discretion of the Chairman, Sindh Non-Muslims Welfare Committee, constituted by the Government of Sindh. Therefore, the complainant may be advised to submit a fresh application for financial aid directly to the Chairman, as per policy, for consideration.

4. Copy of the agency's reports has been forwarded to the complainant for information and compliance.

Contd.....

(2)

FINDING

5. No case of maladministration has been established on part of the Agency.

DECISION

6. In view of above, the complaint is disposed of as rejected.

Given under my hand and seal of the office



Sd /-
(Muhammad Sohail Rajput)
Sitara-e-Imtiaz. PAS
Ombudsman Sindh

Karachi, dated

26.11.2025

